

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Scrum Mastering I: Learning Objectives

Fifteen modules. Each module maps directly to one chapter of Scrum Mastering I: Facilitating Improvement. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the Recognized Scrum Master 1 credential.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The book and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in How 3Back Approaches Learning, 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

MODULE 01

Scrum in a Nutshell

- 1.1 Explain Scrum as Teams using agility to develop Products in a complex environment.
- 1.2 Describe the Scrum Team as a small, indivisible group that produces Results for Stakeholders.
- 1.3 Distinguish Product Owner value accountability from Scrum Master improvement work.
- 1.4 Explain how the Product Owner orders the Backlog toward a Product Goal.
- 1.5 Describe Sprint Planning as agreeing a Sprint Goal and a Sprint Backlog.
- 1.6 Contrast a Product Owner canceling a Sprint with a Scrum Master Abnormal Termination.
- 1.7 Outline the Product Review and Team Retrospective that end a Sprint.

MODULE 02

The Scrum Team

- 2.1 Identify Team Member, Product Owner, and Scrum Master as the on-Team roles.
- 2.2 Distinguish Business Owner, Stakeholder, and Subject Matter Expert as outside-the-Team roles.
- 2.3 Explain why the Team must be self-contained and self-organized, yet not self-directed.
- 2.4 Describe the seven Team Values the book asks Team Members to live.
- 2.5 Explain Commitment as loyalty to Team and Product rather than management demands.
- 2.6 Use Retrospectives and Intraspectives to inspect whether the Team actually lives its Values.

MODULE 03

The Team's Scrum Master

- 3.1 State the Scrum Master's goal of getting the Team to Performing and keeping it there.
- 3.2 Explain that Scrum Master authority is moral authority granted by the Team.
- 3.3 List the sub-roles of Facilitator, Teacher, Referee, Conscience, and Canary.
- 3.4 Describe Retrospectives and Intraspectives as the main engines of Team improvement.
- 3.5 Explain why Organizational constraints must be honored rather than ignored.
- 3.6 Identify Clean Code, Product Ownership, and self-organization as the main issues to manage.
- 3.7 Facilitate Team decisions with a show of hands, thumb voting, or Fist-of-Five.

MODULE 04

Modes of the Scrum Master

- 4.1 Relate Trainer, Coach, Mentor, and Invisible modes to Tuckman maturity phases.
- 4.2 Describe Trainer work during Forming and Storming on basic Scrum.
- 4.3 Apply the Coach Intraspective script: How's that working, What should we do, Just Sayin.
- 4.4 Explain how Mentoring in Performing pushes the Team toward hyper-performance.
- 4.5 Explain why an official Scrum Master stays accountable when the role turns Invisible.

MODULE 05

People Outside the Team

- 5.1 Distinguish the Business Owner, Stakeholder, and Subject Matter Expert roles.
- 5.2 Compare Product Owner alone, paired with a Business Owner, and in a hierarchy.
- 5.3 Explain why only the Team Product Owner may change Team priorities.
- 5.4 Describe the Business Owner as the person the Product Owner is officially accountable to.
- 5.5 Apply the Buddy-Up pattern so a Team Member stays accountable when a SME helps.
- 5.6 Keep Stakeholders from directing Team Members around the Product Owner.

MODULE 06

The Team Swarm

- 6.1 Define the Team Swarm as TeamLets finishing Stories rather than people finishing tasks.
- 6.2 Distinguish Coordinator and Swarmer inside a TeamLet working one Story.
- 6.3 Explain why a person may coordinate only one Story while swarming on others.
- 6.4 Compare Single Item Flow, Pairing, Mob Programming, and Three People at a Whiteboard.
- 6.5 Describe why a swarming Story Board stays at Not Started, In Progress, and Done.
- 6.6 Treat Product Owner and Scrum Master as Professional Swarmers, not Coordinators.
- 6.7 Explain why the Daily Scrum exists largely to keep the Team Swarm organized.

MODULE 07

Leadership

- 7.1 Define the Team Captain as the member accountable to Stakeholders for Team results.
- 7.2 Contrast managing and directing with the book's idea of real Leadership.
- 7.3 Describe Emergent Leadership as informal leadership that arises as needed.
- 7.4 Explain why the Team Captain keeps accountability and does not blame the Team.
- 7.5 Use shared How decisions so trust and respect can grow between Team and Team Captain.

MODULE 08

The Backlog

- 8.1 Describe the Backlog as Team-owned work used to select work and inform Stakeholders.
- 8.2 Explain that any Stakeholder may add an Item while only the Product Owner orders work.
- 8.3 Distinguish Freezer, Fridge, Back Burner, and Front Burner levels of the Backlog.
- 8.4 Keep the Back Burner small so Ready Stories stay inventory rather than waste.
- 8.5 Track Epic quotas so Stakeholders can see Done work, progress, Ready work, and out-of-scope work.

MODULE 09

Technical Debt

- 9.1 Define Technical Debt as work that meets Acceptance Criteria but not the Standard of Care.
- 9.2 Explain why software Technical Debt stays with the Team after delivery.
- 9.3 Describe Clean Code as code the Team is not afraid to change.
- 9.4 Identify fear of changing code as a major impediment to agility.
- 9.5 Explain why the Scrum Master must aggressively manage Technical Debt on code-based Products.

MODULE 10

The Story's Definition of Done

- 10.1 Explain the Definition of Done as what the Team actually agreed to try in the Sprint.
- 10.2 Separate Acceptance Criteria, the right thing, from Standard of Care, the right way.
- 10.3 Describe a Definition of Done for coding, analysis, infrastructure, and research Stories.
- 10.4 Describe how an Epic's Definition of Done differs from a small Story's.
- 10.5 Use the Definition of Done as the contract that lets the Team own its effort.
- 10.6 Split a Story when the Team cannot yet own what Done means.

MODULE 11

Velocity, Size, and Effort

- 11.1 Explain why Velocity, Size, and Effort sit outside the Scrum framework.
- 11.2 Measure software Velocity with Releases, Features, and Passing Acceptance Tests.
- 11.3 Distinguish work that provides Velocity from work that provides Value without Velocity.
- 11.4 Describe how Environmental Variables make Sprint Backlog estimates unreliable.

MODULE 12

Backlog Refinement

- 12.1 Define Ready as a Story that needs less than a 10 minute discussion in Planning.
- 12.2 Extract Stories from Epics and draft Definitions of Done before Planning.
- 12.3 Compare Refinement Sessions with Refinement Stories as ways to prepare work.
- 12.4 Contrast Continuous Improvement, Defined Feature Delivery, and Fuzzy Feature Delivery.
- 12.5 Prioritize using business value, architectural significance, dependencies, and people availability.
- 12.6 Limit Back Burner refinement so unused Ready work does not become waste.

MODULE 13

Planning Day

- 13.1 Sequence Product Review, Retrospective, Progress Assessment, and Sprint Planning on Planning Day.
- 13.2 Limit the Product Review to Done Results and Stakeholder product feedback.
- 13.3 Use the Retrospective to protect working practices, live Values, and select a Kaizen.
- 13.4 Describe Agreement-Based Planning as agreeing Stories one by one until the Sprint is full.
- 13.5 Explain why the Team commits to a Sprint Goal that supplies wiggle room instead of locking the Sprint Backlog.
- 13.6 Explain why Velocity-based Planning is no longer the recommended pattern in this book.

MODULE 14

The Daily Scrum

- 14.1 Explain the Daily Scrum as a daily inspect and adapt point, not a status meeting.
- 14.2 Use Daily Scrum information to schedule re-planning, impediment, Intraspective, and scope talks.
- 14.3 Explain why Daily Scrum adaptations must not change the committed Sprint Goal.
- 14.4 Ask Coordinators what happened to each Story when the Team is Swarming.

MODULE 15

Scaling an Organization

- 15.1 Define Scaling as Structure and Governance changes that enable growth.
- 15.2 Describe growth pressure that forces hiring, outsourcing, and new Team Leaders.
- 15.3 Identify splitting Teams and adding a Product Ownership layer as common scaling patterns.
- 15.4 Explain absorbing another Organization and centralizing work to exploit economies of scale.
- 15.5 Adjust centralization by returning some Client contact to DevTeams to improve reaction time.